Launch Control XL 3 — Kick Lab (lab/kick)

Seven kick candidates for the continuum, all tuned to A. Pull up one fader at a time, or solo with button 1. Column 8: a quiet house loop as context, room for all, rhythm and tempo.

House wants the driest kick: listen to 3, 4 and 5 with Room at 0. Then turn Room up and hear how a tail blurs the groove.

The status box at the bottom right shows every value with units.

Knob | Fader | Button | unused

Mode 16 — Kick Lab

	1 Ambient: soft pulse	2 Ambient: deep 808	3 House: 909 dry	4 House: 909 + body	5 Deep house: 707	6 Techno: 909 driven	7 Techno: sine + FM	8 Context
Row 1	CC 13 **Softness** 2–30 ms attack: the click fades away, a soft thump.	CC 14 **Length** 0.2–1.5 s: the 808's long boom.	CC 15 **Length** 80–600 ms: house = short (~150–250 ms), the groove breathes between the kicks.	CC 16 **Body** 0–1: a sine on A1 under the 909 (the 909's click and punch, a tuned, round body).	CC 17 **Length** 80–500 ms.	CC 18 **Drive** 0–0.9: from warm to hard (hard techno kicks are heavily driven).	CC 19 **Punch** 12–36 semitones pitch drop: from round to a hard “zap”.	CC 20 **Room** 0 = all kicks dry (the house way) ↔ every kick in a room: hear what a tail does to the groove.
Row 2	CC 21 **Length** 0.25–0.9 s: the body.	CC 22 **Tone** 100 Hz–2 kHz low-pass.	CC 23 **Click** 0–1: an extra short noise click on top.	CC 24 **Body length** 0.12–0.6 s.	CC 25 **Warmth** 0–0.6: soft saturation, a rounder, fuller kick.	CC 26 **Length** 80–400 ms.	CC 27 **Length** 0.15–0.5 s.	CC 28 —
Row 3	CC 29 **Tone** 120 Hz–3 kHz low-pass: from felt to a little click.	CC 30 **Tune** ±5 semitones (the sample's speed).	CC 31 **Tune** ±3 semitones.	CC 32 **909** 0–1: how much of the 909 on top.	CC 33 **Tone** 300 Hz–12 kHz low-pass: darker = deeper, more classy.	CC 34 **Tone** 300 Hz–10 kHz low-pass after the drive.	CC 35 **FM** 0–3: overtones on the attack, a darker, metallic thud.	CC 36 —
Fader Level	CC 5 **Level** 007's kick: a sine on A1, no sample. Little click, slow attack.	CC 6 **Level** the long 808 kick: a deep, soft boom, hip hop and ambient pop.	CC 7 **Level** the classic house kick: 909, dry and short.	CC 8 **Level** modern house: layered kick, tuned body, still dry.	CC 9 **Level** the rounder, older kick of deep house (TR-707).	CC 10 **Level** the 909 kick with drive: Berlin techno.	CC 11 **Level** 008's kick: a synthesized sine on A1, hard and short.	CC 12 **Context** a quiet dry house loop: off-beat hat, clap on 2 and 4, bass on A.
Buttons 1	CC 37 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 38 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 39 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 40 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 41 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 42 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 43 **Solo** only this kick; press again = all.	CC 44 **Rhythm** 4/4 → half time → 4/4 + pickup.
Buttons 2	CC 45 **Glide** on: glides up into A (007's soft boom).	CC 46 **HPF 40** on: high-pass at 40 Hz, tighter and less boomy.	CC 47 **HPF 40** on: high-pass at 40 Hz, tighter.	CC 48 **Saturation** on: a little drive, rounder and louder.	CC 49 **LinnDrum** on: LinnDrum instead, tighter, 80s.	CC 50 **Hard** on: a bigger pitch drop on top, more punch.	CC 51 **909 click** on: a little 909 on top for the click.	CC 52 **Tempo** 120 → 124 → 128 → 140 BPM.

Guide

What to listen for

Click (the first few ms: audible on small speakers), punch (the pitch drop, 20-80 ms), body (the low tail). House: short body, firm click, no reverb. Techno: harder click or drive, shorter body, the space comes from the rumble. Ambient: little click, slow attack, a little room.

How to compare

Context fader up (column 8), then one kick at a time for 8 bars. Then solo against each other with button 1. Check on small speakers too: a kick without click disappears there.

Why tuned

Kick, rumble, sub and bass sit in the same octave. A kick on A sounds like one instrument with the bass; off-key it makes the low end muddy.